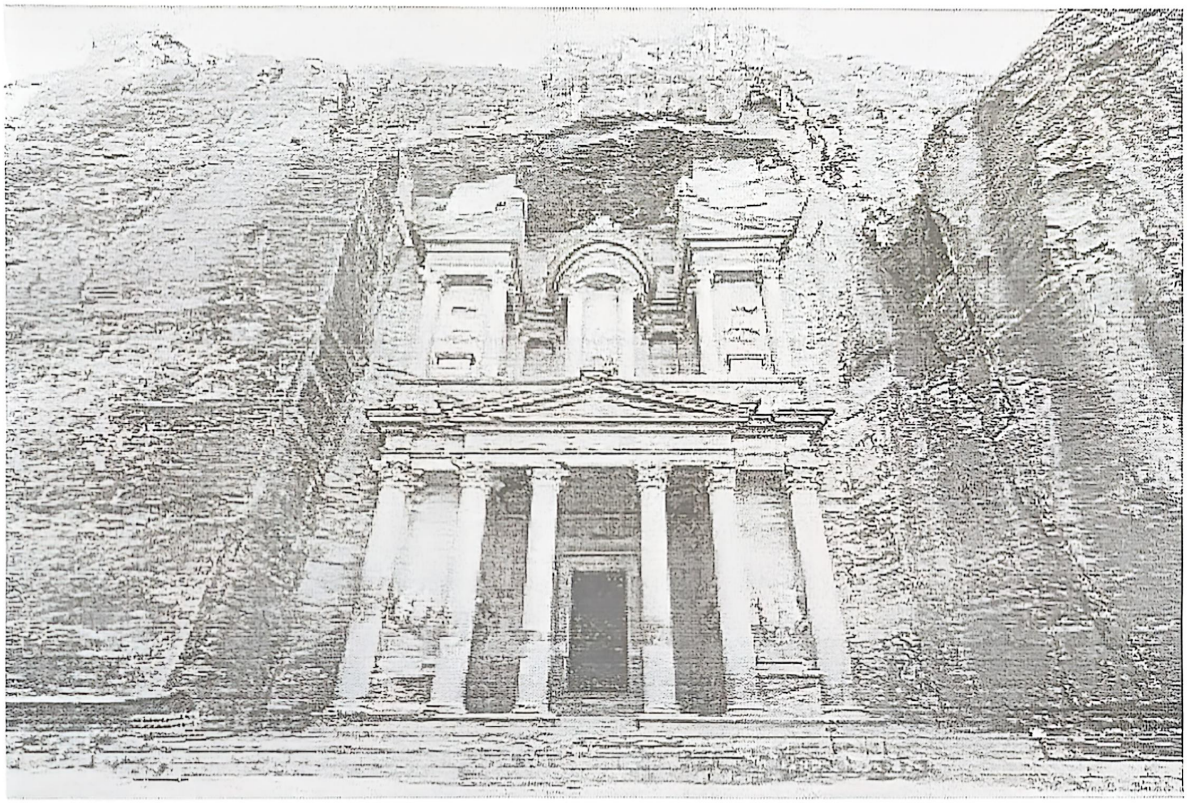
PRE-READING

1. Warm-Up Discussion (5 min):

Reflect and share opinion on these questions:

- What ancient city or ruin would you like to visit—and why?
- Do you know of any ancient architecture carved into rock?

2. Visual Prediction (5 min):



- *Where* do you think this is located?
- *How do you think this structure was constructed?*
- *Do you know of any historical or cultural significance*?

READING

Skim through the passage and underline key words/ terms:

Go Inside Jordan's Stunning City of Stone

The caves, temples, and tombs of Petra reveal an impressive civilization.

Source: A Guide to Petra, Jordan | National Geographic

The "Rose City" is a honeycomb of hand-hewn caves, temples, and tombs carved from blushing pink sandstone in the high desert of Jordan some 2,000 years ago. Hidden by time and shifting sand, Petra tells of a lost civilization. Little is known about the Nabateans—a nomadic desert people whose kingdom rose up from these cliffs and peaks, and whose incredible wealth grew from the lucrative incense trade.

Raqmu, or Petra (as the Greeks knew it), grew into the Nabateans' most prominent city, linking camel caravans between the Mediterranean and Arabian Seas, from Egypt to Syria and beyond to Greece. Control of water sources and an almost magic ability to vanish into the cleft rocks ensured the Nabateans remained unconquered for centuries.

The Romans arrived in 63 B.C., signaling a new era of massive expansion and grandiose construction, like the theater that sat more than 6,000 spectators, as well as some of the city's most impressive facades. Carved into the rock face, the Treasury and the Monastery both have unmistakable Hellenistic features, with ornate Corinthian columns, bas-relief Amazons, and fanciful acroteria. Knowing that such architectural feats were achieved by carving from the top down makes it even more impressive.

Petra's engineering phenomena are legion, including the sophisticated water system that supported some 30,000 inhabitants. Carved into the twisted passageway of the Siq, the irrigation channel drops only 12 feet over the course of a mile, while underground cisterns stored runoff to be used in drier times of the year.

Camels rest in front of the Treasury, a structure carved into the Petra sandstone by ancient Nabataeans in the second century A.D.

Photograph by Jon Arnold Images Ltd, Alamy Stock Photo

And yet it's the raw beauty of Petra that draws in so many millions of visitors—the entire city of ruins is a work of art, painted on a natural stone backdrop that changes color every hour. The elegant Silk Tomb swirls with streaks of red, blue, and ocher, while vivid mosaics still pave the floors of a Byzantine-era church.

Christianity came to Petra in the third and fourth centuries and flourished, but the city waned after an A.D. 336 earthquake and under the early Islamic dynasties of the seventh century.

Petra was only rediscovered by Swiss explorer Johann Burckhardt in 1812, and it continues to spill its secrets. Even now, archaeologists have explored less than half of the sprawling site, and in 2016, with the help of satellite imagery, a monumental structure was found still buried in the sand. It's no wonder that Petra remains Jordan's top tourist attraction and one of the most revered of the World Heritage sites.

Petra is a three-hour drive from Amman and two hours from the Red Sea port of Aqaba. Buses run the route daily, along with organized tours and private taxis. The Jordan Trail passes through Petra, allowing hikers to connect with Dana or Wadi Rum.

Reducing Petra to a single day trip is a common mistake. Remember that Petra spreads out for over a hundred square miles—four times the size of Manhattan. While donkeys, camels, and horse buggies can hasten travel time between highlights, most of Petra's sites are best reached on foot. Come ready to hike some steep terrain.

Spend at least one night in town, and plan your sightseeing as a series of hikes. Petra's licensed guides have exceptional knowledge and will add a deeper dimension to your visit by showing you secret tombs and hidden details you would never find on your own. Don't miss the "Petra by night" show that delivers a haunting and unforgettable visual.

Petra is open year-round, so choose your own adventure: Spring and fall offer the most temperate weather, with fantastic light. Summer is beautiful but can turn unbearably hot. January and February are the coolest months, with the occasional downpour. Remember the high elevation means nights are cold. Sunrise and sunset are when Petra truly glows with changing color, so come early and stay late.

I. **Work in pairs. Ask your partner about the meaning/explanation of the highlighted words/terms. Make notes of the words you did not know below:**

Hellenistic, Acpotania Trail, Buggies Sprawling

① Hellenistic → Noun → Related to a culture.

② Acnotania → Curved Designs

③ Trail → pathway some kind of.

④ Buggies → small four-wheeled vehicles

⑤ Sprawling → Mesmerizing

II. Complete the following summary with words/ phrases taken from the passage:

Petra, often referred to as the "~~pink sandstone~~ rose city" (color nickname), is a magnificent ancient city located in present-day Jordan. Once the thriving capital of the Nabatean kingdom, Petra flourished around the first century B.C. thanks to its strategic position along major ~~trading~~ trade routes.

One of Petra's most iconic landmarks is **Al-Khazneh**, also known as the "_____." This intricate structure is carved directly into the _____ cliffs and stands at the end of a narrow, winding gorge called the _____.

Despite being surrounded by desert, Petra's builders developed a sophisticated ~~sophisticated~~ irrigation system that allowed the city to store and control water. This engineering marvel contributed to Petra's ~~inhabitance~~ prosperity and growth in the harsh climate.

Rediscovered by Western explorers in the 19th century, Petra is now a UNESCO world heritage site and attracts visitors from all over the world. Its stunning architecture, religious tombs, and water management systems reveal the ingenuity and artistry of the Nabatean people.

Today, Petra stands as a powerful symbol of both Jordanian heritage and the importance of preserving the world's most ~~prominent~~ archaeological sites.

III. Read the article carefully. Then decide if the following statements are True, False, or Not Given based on the information in the passage.

- True = The statement agrees with the information in the passage.
- False = The statement contradicts the information in the passage.
- Not Given = The passage does not say whether the statement is true or false.

1. Petra was carved into rose-colored cliffs by the Nabataeans. ~~False~~ True
2. The city of Petra was built entirely for religious purposes. False
3. The Siq is a narrow gorge that leads to Petra's famous Treasury. Not Given.
4. Petra's advanced water system helped it survive in the desert. True
5. Petra remained a powerful city until the Roman Empire collapsed. Not Given
6. Al-Khazneh was once used as a royal palace for Nabataean kings. Not Given

7. Petra is one of the most visited tourist sites in modern Jordan. True

8. The Nabataeans built Petra with the help of Egyptian architects. Not Given

POST READING

Work in small groups (3-4) to discuss the questions for 10 minutes. Create mock interview session where one member from a group will play the role of an interview host while two other members from a different group will be the discussants.

Questions:

1. Why do you think Petra is considered one of the most fascinating archaeological sites in the world?
2. What do the architectural features of Petra reveal about the Nabataean civilization?
3. How did Petra's water management system contribute to its success?
4. What challenges do sites like Petra face today? (e.g. tourism, erosion, climate change)
5. Why is it important to preserve historical sites like Petra for future generations?

7. Petra is one of the most visited tourist sites in modern Jordan.

8. The Nabataeans built Petra with the help of Egyptian architects.

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